Korobochka (コロボ) @cirnosad

Feb 19, 2023 · 9 tweets · cirnosad/status/1627210283877027841

What happened between Putin and Lukashenko?

Prior to the initial phase of the SMO, Belarus wanted to punish Europe for its attempted coup against the sitting government. Therefore it allowed Russia to use both its airspace and border to attack Ukraine.

Belarus Says Will Join Ukraine Offensive 'Only' if Attacked - The Mosc…
President Alexander Lukashenko said Thursday that Belarus would join the offensives in Ukraine "only if attacked" first by Kyiv's army.
https://www.themoscowtimes.com/2023/02/16/belarus-says-will-join-ukraine-offensive-…

Initially, the SMO went well, Hostomel was secured. ZNPP and more. It seemed like Russia was back and Europe feared Putin's red line thread so nothing happened to Belarus as a consequence of its involvement in the war.
Then things began to sour.

NATO began to escalate its support. Russian troops began to stall, especially in the failed attempt to secure the SUNPP.
Worst of all, with Moskova sunk, without retaliation, and Russia forced to withdraw from Kiev and other areas, Luka risked being left holding the bag.

At this point, Lukashenko reoriented his policy:

1. No attack on Ukraine from Belarusian territory, including missile strikes and border crossings would be permitted.
2. He allowed Russia, nevertheless to station troops and planes inside Belarus and upgrade its AD.

3. He announced publicly and privately, that clause 1 will immediately be invalidated the moment a single shell crossed into Belarus from any border, including Poland or Ukraine.

Lukashenko might want Russia to win, he might want the dream of a reunited Russia, but he has responsibilities of his own towards his own people.

So he has reorientated the situation, using the threat of Russia to hold back the threat of NATO, without paying a drop of blood.
Lukashenko learnt from Assad, who allowed Russia to reopen Tartous in 2008, to be rewarded for it with 12 years of Russian inaction and sabotage.
As a land-locked nation, Belarus cannot afford to be stabbed in the back by the Kremlin. So this is as much as they'll get.

There's only two ways Lukashenko might change his policy:
a) If Russia attempts or supports another coup against him -- then things will turn ugly for the Kremlin.
b) If the Kremlin proves it's willing to retaliate and protect its own territory like Belgorod and Crimea.

Until then, the subject will remain closed.
Without Belarus' participation, SMO 2 is basically impossible.

This is why you now hear Lukashenko push for peace and dialogue. He doesn't want to be left holding Putin's bags should the latter decide to "go soft" again.
/End

• • •